

Tuesday, 26 May 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

36° 23°

BIRMINGHAM

Overcast

35° 22°

MANCHESTER

Mostly clear

32° 20°

GLASGOW

Overcast

24° 14°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1

Green MP Carla Denyer to take leave of absence due to 'burnout'.

Carla Denyer said she was taking "several weeks" off to recover from burnout

POLITICS · UK

2

Metal detectorist finds WW2 soldier's silver cigarette case hundreds of miles from where he died.

Stan Drew's cigarette case turns up in a Netherlands field, about 370 miles from where he died.

UK · NEWS

3

How free bus travel for young people has fared in Scotland.

As England moves to give people under the age of 15 free bus travel, under-22s in Scotland have had free bus passes for four years.

UK · NEWS

02 – SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

1

Author of Rivals told writers to stop making her 'macho men' cry.

Novelist Dame Jilly Cooper scolded the team behind Rivals, an executive producer on the show says.

SHOWBIZ · UK

2

New James Bond game shows more vulnerable side to iconic British spy.

The video game presents a young Bond before he has earned his "00" spy status.

SHOWBIZ · UK

3

US site apologises to Outlander star over Shotts 'armpit' misquote.

The transcript shows Catriona Balfe made the comment about about a "particular place" in the town, rather than Shotts as a whole.

SHOWBIZ · UK

On the schedule

1

TT opening day cut short after 'serious incident'.

Organisers say there will be no further activity following a serious incident at Parliament Square.

SPORT · UK

2

Sunderland beat Chelsea to qualify for Europa League.

Sunderland beat Chelsea to qualify for European competition for the first time in 53 years, securing a place in the Europa League at the visitors' expense.

SPORT · UK

3

Which side were remarkable? Who were a shambles? Phil McNulty's season review.

BBC Sport chief football writer Phil McNulty reviews every team's Premier League - and looks back at his pre-season predictions.

SPORT · UK

4

Lamine Yamal in Spain squad but no Real Madrid players.

Injured forward Lamine Yamal is named in Spain's World Cup squad, which does not feature any Real Madrid players.

SPORT · UK

Quick hits

- 1 Almost 70% of UK households now have a smart speaker — but the most common use is still 'asking what time it is'.**

Researchers say we under-use the devices we own. Setting timers, playing music and weather queries make up two thirds of all commands.

- 2 Britain's most-stolen supermarket item in 2026 isn't meat or cheese — it's olive oil, with theft up 220% year on year.**

Prices have nearly doubled in two years. Some shops have fitted security tags to single bottles, others have moved premium brands behind the counter — like cigarettes.

- 3 The 'silver gamer' is the fastest-growing demographic in UK gaming — over-65s spent £180 million on games last year.**

Cosy life-sim titles like Stardew Valley and Animal Crossing dominate. Console makers are reportedly designing larger UI for the market.

- 4 The most-Googleed DIY question in Britain this year: 'how to remove silicone'.**

Tradespeople say it's the rise of botched bathroom resealing jobs during lockdown that's still haunting people. YouTube tutorials on the topic have racked up 60 million views.

- 5 British baby names are getting shorter again — three- and four-letter names are dominating the registrar.**

Top picks this year: Noa, Ezra, Ada and Bo. Long, multi-syllable Victorian names like Theodora are sliding back down the chart.

- 6 The average Brit checks their phone 159 times a day — but says it 'doesn't feel like that much'.**

Researchers using passive monitoring apps say we badly underestimate our own usage. Most people guess between 30 and 70 times.

- 7 More than half of UK workers would take a 10% pay cut to never go into the office again — but only 17% of bosses say they'd offer one.**

The gap is growing again after forced return-to-office rules. HR experts say the tension shows up in resignation rates, particularly for under-35s.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q 44% of us have done **THIS** while waiting for a kettle to boil. What?
ANSWER: WANDERED OFF AND FORGOTTEN ABOUT IT ENTIRELY.

Q 75% of us check **THIS** more than ten times a day. What?
ANSWER: THE WEATHER APP.

TALK TOPIC

- **If you won the lottery tonight, what's the FIRST thing you'd buy tomorrow?**
Talk-back: not the dream house. Not the holiday. The first daft thing you'd buy because you finally could.
- **What's the worst job you've ever had — and how long did you last?**
Talk-back: the war stories are usually the funniest. Bonus marks for under a fortnight.

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **UK News.** A Yorkshire farmer has won a planning row by getting his prize-winning sheep listed as 'agricultural heritage', preventing a housing development from going ahead next to his field.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** A Cornish café has started charging customers extra if they ask for the WiFi password before placing their order, claiming it 'improves table turnover by 40%'.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The colour orange is named after the fruit, not the other way around.
- More people speak English in China than in the United States.
- Cleopatra lived closer in time to the moon landing than to the building of the Great Pyramid.
- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time — 1/100th of a second.
- Goats have rectangular pupils, which gives them nearly 360-degree vision.
- Lightning strikes Earth about 100 times every second.
- Bees have to visit roughly 2 million flowers to make one pound of honey.
- Mosquitoes are attracted to people who've just eaten bananas.

On this day

Day 146 of the year, 219 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Andrew Kaggwa; Christian feast day: Augustine of Canterbury (Anglican Communion and Eastern Orthodox); Christian feast day: Lambert of Vence; Christian feast day: Mariana de Jesús de Paredes. Star sign Gemini, birthstone Emerald.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1978 — Dan Parks, Australian-Scottish rugby player
- 1949 — Hank Williams Jr., American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1938 — William Bolcom, American pianist and composer
- 1975 — Lauryn Hill, American singer-songwriter, producer, and actress
- 1976 — Paul Collingwood, English cricketer and coach
- 1953 — Michael Portillo, English journalist, politician and TV presenter
- 1954 — Alan Hollinghurst, English novelist, poet, short story writer, and translator
- 1949 — Pam Grier, American actress

THE DAY TODAY

- 1983 — The 7.8 Mw Sea of Japan earthquake shakes northern Honshu with a maximum Mercalli intensity of VIII (Severe). A destructive tsunami is generated that leaves about 100 people dead.
- 1967 — The Beatles' album Sgt. Pepper's Lonely Hearts Club Band is released.
- 2025 — 65 people are injured when a car rams into a crowd on Water Street, near Liverpool F.C.'s Premier League trophy parade.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1967 — The Beatles' album Sgt. Pepper's Lonely Hearts Club Band is released.
- 1981 — Italian Prime Minister Arnaldo Forlani and his coalition cabinet resign following a scandal over membership of the pseudo-masonic lodge P2 (Propaganda Due).

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1971 — Bangladesh Liberation War: The Pakistan Army slaughters at least 71 Hindus in Burunga, Sylhet, Bangladesh.
- 1991 — Lauda Air Flight 004 breaks apart in mid-air and crashes in the Phu Toei National Park in the Suphan Buri province of Thailand, killing all 223 people on board.

- 2008 — Severe flooding begins in eastern and southern China that will ultimately cause 148 deaths and force the evacuation of 1.3 million.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 147 of the year, 218 days left in 2026. Today Armed Forces Day (Nicaragua); Children's Day (Nigeria); Christian feast day: Augustine of Canterbury; Christian feast day: Blessed Lojze Grozde. Star sign Gemini, birthstone Emerald.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1962 — Steven Brill, American actor, director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1965 — Todd Bridges, American actor
- 1970 — Joseph Fiennes, English actor
- 1973 — Jack McBrayer, American actor and comedian
- 1966 — Heston Blumenthal, English chef and author
- 1935 — Ramsey Lewis, American jazz pianist and composer (died 2022)
- 1974 — Derek Webb, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1948 — Pete Sears, English bass player

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2016 — Barack Obama is the first president of the United States to visit Hiroshima Peace Memorial Park and meet Hibakusha.
- 2018 — Maryland Flood Event: A flood occurs throughout the Patapsco Valley, causing one death, destroying the entire first floors of buildings on Main Street in Ellicott City, and causing cars to overturn.
- 1984 — The Danube–Black Sea Canal is opened, in a ceremony attended by the Ceaușescus. It had been under construction since the 1950s.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1971 — Pakistani forces massacre over 200 civilians, mostly Bengali Hindus, in the Bagmati massacre.
- 1958 — First flight of the McDonnell Douglas F-4 Phantom II.

Coming to cinemas

MAY 2026	
FRI 15	Mortal Kombat II (+ IMAX); Is God Is; Poetic License
FRI 22	The Mandalorian and Grogu (+ IMAX)
JUNE 2026	
FRI 5	Masters of the Universe; Power Ballad
FRI 12	Scary Movie 6; new Spielberg film (+ IMAX)
FRI 19	Pixar's Toy Story 5
FRI 26	Supergirl: Woman of Tomorrow (+ IMAX); A Private Life
JULY 2026	
WED 1	Minions & Monsters
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome
SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

MAY 2026		JULY 2026	
THU 14	PGA Championship begins (Golf)	4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
WED 20	UEFA Europa League Final	SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
SAT 23	EFL Championship Play-off Final, Wembley	16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
SUN 24	Premier League final day (all 10 games, 3pm BST)	18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
24 MAY – 7 JUN	French Open (Tennis)	23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
THU 28	Premier League Darts Finals Night	AUGUST 2026	
SAT 30	UEFA Champions League Final	W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
JUNE 2026		SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
THU 4	NBA Finals begin	22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)
11 JUN – 19 JUL	FIFA World Cup (USA / Canada / Mexico)		
11–14 JUN	World Cup of Darts		
12 JUN – 5 JUL	ICC Women's T20 World Cup (England & Wales)		
18–21 JUN	U.S. Open (Golf)		
29 JUN – 12 JUL	Wimbledon		